

The 8-Minute Rule

Medicare Part B · SNF Therapy · Unit Billing Quick Reference · 2026

Minutes → Units			
Minutes	Units	Notes	
1–7 min	0	Below threshold — cannot bill	
8–22 min	1	8+ mins = 1 unit	
23–37 min	2	23+ mins = 2 units	
38–52 min	3	38+ mins = 3 units	
53–67 min	4	53+ mins = 4 units	
68–82 min	5	68+ mins = 5 units	
83–97 min	6	83+ mins = 6 units	
98–112 min	7	98+ mins = 7 units	
		8	min minimum to bill 1 unit of any timed code
		15	min = 1 full unit
		23	min = 2 units
		38	min = 3 units
		KEY	Each code is counted independently — not pooled across the session
		KEY	Evals are NOT timed — flat fee regardless of time
		KEY	Group/concurrent time does NOT count toward 8-min individual units
Multi-Code Examples			
Codes	Time	Units	Notes
97530 + 97110	20 + 20 min	3 units	20 min = 2 units; 20 min = 1 unit (hits 8-min threshold)
97530 + 97112	15 + 7 min	1 unit	97530 = 1 unit; 97112 only 7 min — below threshold, 0 units
97533 + 97530	30 + 20 min	4 units	2 + 2 units. MPPR: 97533 at 100%, 97530 drops to 50%
97110+97112+97530	15+15+15	3 units	Each code gets its own count — 1+1+1
92526 + 97129	30 + 8 min	3 units	2 + 1 units. 97129 just meets the 8-min threshold
Common Mistakes			
Pooling total session time	Units are per code — 40 min of one code = 3 units, not split differently if multiple codes used.		
Billing < 8 min	A code with only 7 minutes = 0 units, even if total session was 60+ minutes.		
No start/stop times	CMS requires individual start/stop times per code — required for audit defense.		
Rounding up	22 min = 1 unit. 23 min = 2 units. Cutoffs are exact — never round up.		
Stacking low-minute codes	3 codes x 7 min each = 0 billable units. Each needs its own 8-min threshold.		